

21 Questions to Ask Before You Pay an Inverter Installer in Lagos

A checklist to walk through before you pay anyone for solar, inverter, or battery installation

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Most bad installations in Lagos do not fail because the equipment was bad. They fail because nobody asked the right question at the right moment. The same few problems keep repeating: an installer who disappears after collecting a deposit, a battery sized by guesswork instead of a proper load calculation, or a changeover switch wired wrong so the house has no power even though the inverter itself is “working.” These are the 21 questions that catch those problems before you pay for them.

Print this out and bring it to every conversation with an installer. Ask each question, and tick the box, before you move to the next stage.

Stage 1: Before you call anyone

- ☐ Do you know what you want to power (fridge, AC units, pumps, lights, TV, router) and roughly how many hours a day?
- ☐ How long has the installer been installing in Lagos, not just how long the company has existed?
- ☐ Can they give you two phone numbers of past customers you can call yourself, not just photos of finished jobs?
- ☐ Is this a registered company or one person working alone, so you know who you are dealing with?

Stage 2: Before you agree to a price

- ☐ Has the installer visited, or asked detailed questions about your appliances, instead of quoting a price over the phone based on “how many rooms”?
- ☐ Have you seen the load calculation in writing: what you want to run, how many watts that adds up to, and why the inverter and battery size match it?
- ☐ Does the quote list the brand and model of every panel, inverter, and battery, not just “inverter” and “battery” as line items?
- ☐ Do you know whether the price includes wiring, changeover switch, mounting, and labour, or whether those are billed separately?
- ☐ Have you gotten at least one other quote to compare, even if you already trust this installer?

Stage 3: Before you pay a deposit

- ☐ Is the workmanship warranty written down: how long it lasts, what it covers if something goes wrong, who comes back to fix it, and whether that costs extra?
- ☐ Are the payment terms written somewhere, even a WhatsApp message with dates and amounts, not just agreed by voice?
- ☐ Do you have the installer’s full name, phone number, and physical address, not just a WhatsApp handle?

Stage 4: On installation day

- ☐ Does the installer separate your essential circuits (fridge, lights, router) from heavy ones (AC, pumping machine, iron) before wiring the changeover switch?
- ☐ Do the cables match the load, since thin, cheap cable on a heavy circuit is a fire risk and not a shortcut worth taking?
- ☐ Can you see the brand names on the panels, inverter, and batteries being installed, and do they match what was quoted?
- ☐ Does the battery room or cabinet have ventilation, since batteries sealed into a hot, airless space fail sooner?
- ☐ Does the installer isolate the circuit before touching any wiring, since that is a basic safety step and not something to skip to save time?

Stage 5: Before you pay the final balance

- ☐ Has the full system been tested under load, meaning appliances were switched on and run, not just checked with a quick light bulb test?
- ☐ Has the installer shown you how to operate it: what the display means, how to switch between grid and battery, and what to do if something trips?
- ☐ Do you have the manufacturer warranty documents, not just the installer's word, for the inverter and battery?
- ☐ Do you have a written record of what was installed, including brands, models, capacity, and the date?

Red flags. Walk away if:

- The installer wants full payment upfront, with no written terms.
- The price changes by a large amount after you have already paid a deposit.
- Nobody can explain, in plain terms, why they chose that inverter and battery size for your load.
- The installer avoids giving you a physical address or a second contact number.
- You are told "it does not need a warranty" or "warranty is not how it works here," since a serious installer offers one anyway.
- The batteries or panels have no visible brand name, or the installer is vague about where they came from.

This checklist was put together by PowerNexa Solutions, based on problems Lagos homeowners describe after a bad installation: installers who disappear, systems sized by guesswork, and wiring that was never tested. If you would rather skip the guesswork, we do a proper load calculation and a written quote before any money changes hands. WhatsApp us at 0813 209 7317 or visit powernexasolutions.site to get started.